

Cole Gibler, LHP, Arkansas

2026 Stats: 5.46 ERA/59.1 IP/59 K/25 BB/2.36 K:BB

6-2, 205

Metrics

FB: 91.7/19 IVB/-10.1 HB/-4.84 VAA/5 ext/6.1 relH/41% zone/51.2 AA/44.5% usage/2020 rpm

SL: 82.4/-2.7 IVB/0.2 HB/-8.57/30.1% zone/54.1 AA/41.9% usage/2060 rpm

CH: 85.5/10.5 IVB/-15.4 HB/-7.07 VAA/21.8% zone/47.8 AA/13.6% usage/1970 rpm

Write-up

Cole Gibler is a broad shoulder lefty out of Arkansas that has a OT slot with big crossfire in the delivery. He sets up far on the 3B side then uses most of his extension to get across nearly wholly onto the 1B side creating a unique angle for his fastball and deathball-y slider. He struggled with walks and the long ball in 2026 but the arsenal is anchored by a solid FB and a pair of intriguing secondaries.

Gibler will need to find CH consistency and a way to keep RHH off the FB in 2027 but he looks like a solid relief option in short stints that could perform in a multi inning role in the future.

The FB has true ride and carries well through the zone considering the high release. He is very good at getting it gloveside to lefties and it successfully stifled them throughout the season. The RHH needs refinement, throwing too many fastballs middle away when trying to get up away. The pitch failed to get above average whiff with just a 16% whiff rate. The pitch is in the zone, just leaking too often over the heart. A 30% barrel rate to RHH is untenable long term. The cross fire OT delivery may be playing a role in this, giving RHH early access to seeing a ball moving in on them. When left on the outer third, RHH rarely missed. Being able to emphasize and use the angle into RHH more is important for

Gibler's development, trusting himself to get into the hands without hitting batters. 40/45 pitch

The SL is the best pitch in the profile, being a downer from a high release and is heavy into the zone.

The spin capacity is low, with the pitch averaging just under 2100 rpm but that didn't stop batters from whiffing at a 33% rate and chasing 37% of pitches. He was exceptional at getting the pitch down

and gloveside where nearly all of his 63 whiffs were. The pitch also did a decent job at managing contact, getting 52% GB and holding righties to a .200 avg, 50/50 pitch

The CH is a good fader with solid velo separation and big vertical and armside movement off the FB. It succeeded off of the fastball in 2026 in pure platoon usage, getting a 19% SWSTR and .216 avg. When left up, Gibler allowed 3 homers on the change but overall he was successful at getting D/A. This above average command shows some of the flaws in the pure zone rate, as RHH chased 40% of CH thrown out of the zone due to them being placed so consistently just off the outside corner. 50/50 pitch